

UNIT 3 / People and things

Der, die or das?

Your goal: Learn nouns together with their definite articles.

01 Learn the idea

German nouns have grammatical gender: masculine der, feminine die and neuter das in the basic subject form. Gender is not the same as biological sex, and it often cannot be guessed from English. Learn der Tisch as one vocabulary item, not Tisch alone. All nouns start with a capital letter.

The definite article points to a particular or known thing, like English the. In the plural, the basic article is die for every gender: die Bücher. Keep a vocabulary notebook with article, noun and plural. Colours can help you organise genders, but the real goal is recalling the article when you say the word.

Words and phrases

German	English
der Tisch	the table
die Lampe	the lamp
das Buch	the book
die Bücher	the books
Das ist der Tisch.	That is the table.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Mia

Was ist das?

What is that?

Ben

Das ist das Buch. Und das ist die Lampe.

That is the book. And that is the lamp.

Mia

Ist das der Tisch?

Is that the table?

Ben

Ja, genau.

Yes, exactly.

Your real-life mission

Label five objects near you with an article and noun. Practise covering the article and recalling it before checking your answer.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “der Tisch” mean?

- A. the lamp
- B. the table
- C. the book

2. What does “die Lampe” mean?

- A. the book
- B. the books
- C. the lamp

3. What does “das Buch” mean?

- A. the book
- B. the books
- C. That is the table.

4. What is the basic definite article for plural nouns?

- A. der
- B. das
- C. die

5. Which object does Ben mention after the book?

- A. A lamp
- B. A chair
- C. A phone

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. B - the table

“der Tisch” means “the table”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. C - the lamp

“die Lampe” means “the lamp”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. A - the book

“das Buch” means “the book”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. C - die

Plural nouns use die in the nominative, regardless of their singular gender.

5. A - A lamp

Ben adds Und das ist die Lampe.

One possible mission response

der Tisch; die Lampe; das Buch; der Stuhl; das Handy.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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